Absorption and storage:

Vitamin E, like other fat soluble vitamins, is absorbed along with fat in the small intestines. It is stored in the liver, muscle and body fat.

Deficiency:

Vitamin E deficiency causes the following conditions in animals.

- Reproductive failure
- Muscular dystrophy
- Combined deficiency of vitamin E and selenium causes hepatic necrosis.

8.1.4 Vitamin K:

Vitamins belonging to the K group are poly isoprenoid substituted naphthoquinones. It is known as the anti-hemorrhagic vitamin.

Three compounds which have the biological activity of vitamin K are:

- Phylloquinone,which is found in green leafy vegetables.
- Menaquinones, which are a family of closely related compounds synthesized by the intestinal bacteria, with different lengths of the side chain.
- Menadione, a synthetic compound which can be metabolized to yield phylloquinone.

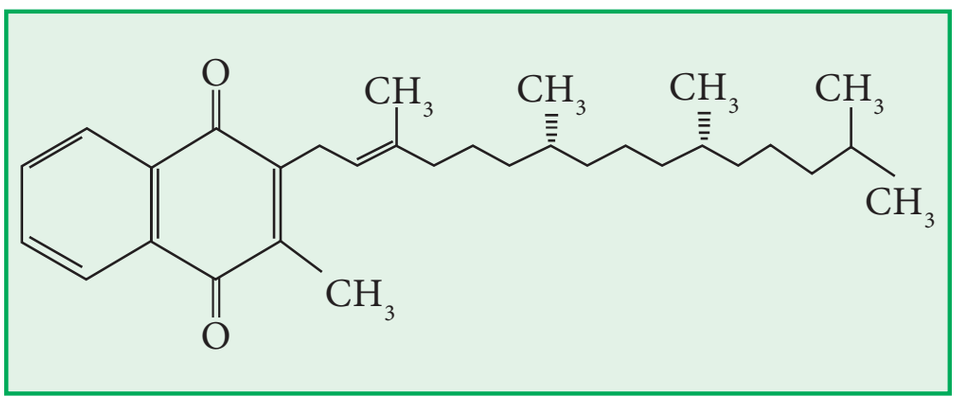

Figure 8.9 Structure of vitamin K

Sources:

Green vegetables, soybean oils, tomatoes, spinach and cabbage are chief plant sources (Fig. 8.10).

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